Topic 4 — Bhakti (भक्ति) & Sufi (सूफी) Movements

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Bhakti Movement | Major Bhakti Saints | Chronology of Bhakti Saints | Indian Saint Tradition | Guru-Shishya Tradition | Tulsidas (तुलसीदास) | Bhakti Period Women Poets | Vedanta (उत्तर मीमांसा) Philosophy | Sufi Saints | Nath Sect | Ramananda (रामानंद) | Kabir (कबीर) | Guru (गुरु) Nanak (गुरु नानक) | Chaitanya (चैतन्य) Mahaprabhu | Mirabai (मीराबाई) | Surdas (सूरदास) | Ravidas | Namdev (नामदेव) | Dadu Dayal | Basavanna (बसवन्ना) | Varkari Tradition | Jayadeva (जयदेव) | Shankaradeva | Nizamuddin Auliya | Moinuddin Chishti (चिश्ती) | Chishti Order (चिश्ती सिलसिला) | Suhrawardi (सुहरावर्दी) Order | Qadiri Order | Naqshbandi (नक्शबंदी) Order | Baba Farid (बाबा फरीद)

Sources baked in: NCERT *Themes in Indian History Part II*, RS Sharma *Medieval India*, **Ghatnachakra** Bhakti and Sufi Movement (B–259+), UPPCS / UKPCS Prelims PYQs **Weight:** ★★★ — guru–disciple matching, saint chronology, Chishti pairs, Vedanta schools, Fawaid-ul-Fuad **Last verified:** September 2026 **Current Affairs:** N/A (purely historical)

4.1 Bhakti Movement — Origins

Personal devotion to God | Vernacular hymns | Social equality | South (**7th c.**) → North (**14th–17th c.**)

What is Bhakti?

- **Bhakti** (भक्ति) means personal, loving devotion to God — not only ritual, sacrifice, or priestly mediation.
- The idea has early roots in the **Shvetashvatara Upanishad (उपनिषद्)** and **Bhagavad Gita** (भगवद्गीता) (Chapter **12** on **Bhakti Yoga (योग)**).
- As a **mass movement**, Bhakti crystallised in **7th-century Tamil Nadu (नाडु)** and later spread north through saints and gurus.

Why did Bhakti grow? (context)

Factor	How it mattered
Turkish conquests	Political uncertainty weakened old temple–court patronage networks in parts of the north.
Sanskrit monopoly	Ordinary people could not access Brahman-controlled Sanskrit ritual religion.
Vernacular need	Saints sang in **Tamil, Marathi, Hindi, Awadhi, Braj, Punjabi, Bengali** and reached peasants and artisans.
Sufi parallel	Chishti **sama**, equality, and love-of-God ideas created a shared moral atmosphere with Bhakti.
Social protest	Many sants challenged **jati (जाति) barriers**, costly pilgrimage, and priestly control over salvation.

> **Key fact:** Bhakti was **not** a movement against Islam. It was mainly **intra-Hindu** reform against empty ritualism, though it shared social space with Sufism.

Phase 1 — South India (7th–12th century)

Tamil land | **Nayanars (Shiva)** + **Alvars (Vishnu)** | Temple-centred hymn tradition

Group	Deity	Number	Main text	Key fact
Nayanars (नायनार)	**Shiva**	**63** saints	**Tevaram** (तेवारम्) hymns	Shaiva Bhakti in Tamil Nadu
Alvars (आलवार)	**Vishnu**	**12** saints	**Divya Prabandham** (~**4000** hymns)	Called the **"Tamil Veda (वेद)"**

- **Appar**, **Sundarar**, and **Sambandar** are the three chief **Nayanar** (नायनार) hymnists whose works form the core of **Tevaram**.
- **Andal** was the only woman among the **12 Alvars** and is famous for her Vishnu hymns.
- **Periyalvar** and **Nammalvar** are among the most celebrated Alvar poets in Tamil Vaishnava tradition.
- **Appar** (a Nayanar) questioned the value of **gotra**, **kula**, and law-books when they blocked devotion to Shiva.
- **Tondaradippodi** (a Brahmana (ब्राह्मण) Alvar) praised servants of Vishnu even when they were born as outcastes — an early anti-caste devotional voice.
- South Bhakti was closely tied to **temple worship**, pilgrimage, and local deity cults — this is the early **saguna** (formed-deity) stream.
- In **12th-century Karnataka**, **Basavanna** led the **Virashaiva/Lingayat** reform — a radical Shaiva Bhakti strand distinct from temple Brahmanism. He rejected caste hierarchy and image worship in the orthodox Vedic sense. Full teaching sits in **§4.17**.

Phase 2 — Philosophical bridge (9th–12th century)

Shankara → **Ramanuja** → **Madhva** | Vedanta schools prepare ground for northward Bhakti

Thinker	School	One-line fact
Shankara	**Advaita** (अद्वैतवाद) (non-dualism)	World is **maya**; Brahman alone is real — intellectual backdrop, not mass Bhakti saint.
Ramanuja	**Vishishtadvaita** (विशिष्टद्वैतवाद) (qualified non-dualism)	God, soul, and world are related; **personal Vishnu bhakti** is the path.
Madhva	**Dvaita** (द्वैतवाद) (dualism)	Soul and God are eternally distinct.

- **Ramanuja (11th century)** made Vishnu bhakti philosophically respectable and opened temple traditions to wider devotion in the south.
- His ideas later fed **Ramananda** in the north, who simplified the message for Gangetic masses.

Phase 3 — North Indian sant tradition (14th–17th century)

Sant parampara | Local **guru–shishya** line | No single church or central institution

Stream	God idea	Representative saints	Key trait
Saguna	Personal God **with form** — Rama, Krishna, Vithoba	**Surdas**, **Tulsidas**, **Mirabai**, **Namdev**	Image, kirtan, emotional love-bhakti
Nirguna	**Formless** one God — Ram/Hari/Allah as names of the same absolute (निरपेक्ष)	**Kabir**, **Nanak**, **Ravidas**, **Dadu Dayal**	Rejected idol-centred ritual for many practices

- **Ramananda (14th–15th century)** settled in **Banaras** and preached **Rama bhakti** open to **all castes and women**.
- He followed **Ramanuja's** broad Vishishtadvaita line but used **Hindi**, not Sanskrit, and reached artisans and peasants.
- **Namdev (~1270–1350)** in Maharashtra was an early north Indian voice devoted to **Vithoba/Krishna** at **Pandharpur**.
- The usual northward chronology runs: **Namdev** → **Kabir** → **Nanak** → **Chaitanya** → **Surdas** → **Tulsidas** → **Dadu Dayal**.

What Bhakti saints rejected and accepted

Rejected	Accepted
Caste monopoly on worship and salvation	**Guru** (personal preceptor)
Sanskrit-only religion for the elite	**Vernacular** song (सोंग) and sermon
Empty **ritualism** without inner love	**Honest livelihood** (weaver, cobbler, farmer saints)
Costly **pilgrimage monopoly** (for many nirguna sants)	**Sangat** (संगत) / congregation bhajan
Brahman control as sole gate to moksha	**Women** and lower castes as devotees and poets

- **Kabir** and **Nanak** sharply rejected **idol worship** and caste markers like the **janeu**.
- **Surdas**, **Tulsidas**, and **Mirabai** belonged to the **saguna** stream and used **Krishna/Rama** devotion with formed deity imagery — do not say "all Bhakti rejected idols."

Women in early and medieval Bhakti

- **Andal** was the famous woman saint among the **Alvars** in Tamil Nadu.
- **Akkamahadevi** was a **12th-century** Shiva devotee in Karnataka associated with the **Virashaiva** (Lingayat) tradition.
- **Mirabai** later became the best-known woman Krishna devotee in north India.
- Bhakti gave **women and lower castes** a public voice through hymn, congregation, and guru lineages.

Social and cultural impact

- Bhakti challenged the **Brahman monopoly** on scripture, ritual, and salvation.
- It created a **decentralised sant parampara** — many local gurus, not one papal-style hierarchy.
- **Bhakti–Sufi synthesis** helped shape **composite culture** in north India.
- Historians link this atmosphere to later ideas of tolerance such as **Akbar (अकबर)'s sulh-i-kul** (do not equate Bhakti with **Din-i-Ilahi** (दीन-ए-इलाही) — that was Akbar's own project).

Origins — quick learn chain

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Upanishads / Gita (idea)
 ↓
Tamil Nadu: 63 Nayanars + 12 Alvars (7th-12th c.)
 ↓
Basavanna / Lingayat (12th c. Karnataka) + Jayadeva / Gita Govinda
 ↓
Ramanuja (11th c.) — Vishishtadvaita bridge
 ↓
Jnaneshwar / Varkari (13th c. Maharashtra) → Namdev
 ↓
Ramananda (14th-15th c.) — Rama bhakti to all castes, Banaras
 ↓
North sants: Namdev → Kabir / Ravidas → Nanak → Chaitanya → Surdas → Tulsidas → Dadu
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> **Logic:** Bhakti did **not** start with Kabir. The **Alvars and Nayanars** are the earliest mass phase. Chronological order: **Namdev** → **Kabir** → **Nanak** → **Chaitanya**.

4.2 Major Bhakti Saints — Master Table

Saint	Region	Language	Tradition	Guru	Key work/trait
Namdev	Maharashtra	Marathi	Vithoba/Krishna	—	Earliest in north list; hymns in Adi Granth
Ramananda	Prayag-Banaras	Hindi	Rama saguna	Ramanuja line	Opened to all castes
Kabir	Kashi (काशी)	Hindi	Nirguna	**Ramananda**	Weaver; dohas; Ram=Allah; died **Maghar**
Ravidas	Varanasi (वाराणसी)	Hindi	Nirguna	**Ramananda**	Cobbler saint
Guru Nanak	Punjab	Punjabi	Nirguna/monotheism	Revelation	**Mardana** companion; 1469–1539
Chaitanya	Bengal	Bengali	Gaudiya Vaishnava	—	Sankirtan; 1486–1533
Surdas	Braj	Braj Bhasha	Krishna saguna	**Vallabhacharya**	Sursagar; blind poet
Tulsidas	Awadh (अवध)/UP	Awadhi	Rama saguna	—	**Ramcharitmanas** ~1574
Mirabai	Mewar (मेवाड़)	Rajasthani/Hindi	Krishna	—	Royal devotee

Saint	Region	Language	Tradition	Guru	Key work/trait
Dadu Dayal	Rajasthan	Hindi	Nirguna	—	Dadu Panth; Nipakhi path
Basavanna	Karnataka	Kannada	Virashaiva/Lingayat	—	Anubhava Mantapa; Vachanas; Ishtalinga
Jnaneshwar	Maharashtra	Marathi	Varkari/Vithoba	Nivruttinath	**Jnaneshwari** (ज्ञानेश्वरी) (Gita commentary)
Jayadeva	Odisha/Puri (पुरी)	Sanskrit	Krishna (Radha)	—	**Gita Govinda** (~12th c.)
Shankaradeva	Assam	Assamese	Eka (एका) Sarana Krishna	—	**Kirtana-ghosha**; satra centres

4.3 Chronology of Bhakti Saints

Order	Saint	Period
1	Alvars / Nayanars	7th–12th c.
1b	**Basavanna** / Lingayat	12th c.
1c	**Jayadeva** (Gita Govinda)	~12th c.
1d	**Jnaneshwar** (Varkari)	13th c.
2	**Namdev**	~1270–1350
3	Ramananda	14th–15th c.
4	**Kabir**	~1398–1518
5	**Guru Nanak**	1469–1539
6	**Chaitanya**	1486–1533
7	Mirabai	~1498–1547
8	Surdas	1478–1581
9	Tulsidas	1532–1623
10	Dadu Dayal	1544–1603

- Chronological order is **Namdev → Kabir → Nanak → Chaitanya**.
- Namdev always comes before Kabir.
- Kabir comes before Nanak.
- Nanak was born earlier than Chaitanya (**1469** versus **1486**).
- Tulsidas belongs to the **16th–17th century** and must never be placed before Kabir.

4.4 Guru–Shishya Tradition (★★★)

Disciple	Guru	Tradition
Kabir	**Ramananda**	Bhakti nirguna
Ravidas	**Ramananda**	Bhakti nirguna
Surdas	**Vallabhacharya**	Pushti Krishna bhakti
Mardana	**Guru Nanak**	Sikh founding companion
Amir Khusrau	**Nizamuddin Auliya**	Chishti Sufi
Amir Hasan Sijzi	Nizamuddin circle	Compiled Fawaid-ul-Fuad

- Hold guru pairs as separate sentences.
- **Kabir's** guru was **Ramananda**.
- **Amir Khusrau's** guru was **Nizamuddin Auliya**.
- **Surdas's** guru was **Vallabhacharya**.
- **Mardana** was **Nanak's** disciple, not his guru.
- In the Sufi model, the **pir–murid** bond links master and disciple, and **silsilah** means the spiritual genealogy chain.
- **Mardana** was Nanak's disciple and companion, not his guru, so do not reverse the pair.

4.5 Ramananda, Namdev & Ravidas

- **Ramananda** was born in a **Kanyakubja Brahmin** family at **Prayag (~1299)**. He was the first major north Indian sant to preach in **Hindi**, and his pupils cut across caste.
- His dictum runs: *Let no man ask a man's sect or caste* — a standard north-India equality fact.
- **Ramananda** (14th–15th century) was born near **Prayag** and settled in **Banaras**.
- He shifted worship from Vishnu to the more accessible **Rama** and opened the path to **all castes and women**.
- Ramananda's famous couplet runs: *"Jat-pat puchhe nahi koi, Hari ko bhaje so Hari ka hoi"* — no one asks caste; whoever worships God belongs to God.
- Tradition lists **12 disciples**, chosen to show deliberate occupational diversity.
- **Kabir** was a weaver.
- **Ravidas** was a cobbler.
- **Sena** was a barber.
- **Dhanna** was a Jat farmer.
- **Pipa** was a Rajput (राजपूत) prince.
- **Sadhana** and others complete the list.
- Philosophically, Ramananda followed **Ramanuja's Vishishtadvaita** but simplified it for the masses and used Hindi instead of Sanskrit.

- **Namdev** (~1270–1350) was a Maharashtra tailor-saint devoted to **Vithoba/Krishna** at **Pandharpur**.
- He composed in **Marathi** and some Hindi.
- Namdev is the **earliest** name in north Indian chronology lists, and **61 of his hymns** appear in the **Guru Granth (गुरु ग्रंथ) Sahib** (गुरु ग्रंथ साहिब).
- **Ravidas** (Raidas) was a Varanasi **chamar/cobbler**, a disciple of Ramananda, and a nirguna monotheist who taught one God beyond caste.
- Ravidas's **Begumpura** concept describes an ideal casteless city without sorrow and shows his radical egalitarianism.
- The **Ravidas Panth** continues today, and his verses in the **Adi Granth** give him a pan-Indian legacy.
- For UPPCS, **Ramananda** is linked to Banaras and Prayag, and **Ravidas** to Varanasi; both are core UP saints.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Ramananda's Social Doctrine (UPPCS & Civil Services Format):** - **Assertion (A):** Ramananda opened Rama bhakti to all castes without distinction. - **Reason (R):** He formulated the egalitarian principle: *"Jati-pati puchhai nahi koi, Hari ko bhaje so Hari ka hoi"* ("Let no man ask a man's sect or caste; whoever worships God belongs to God"). - **Disciples:** Included Kabir (weaver), Ravidas (cobbler), Sena (barber), Sadhana (butcher), Dhanna (Jat farmer), Narhari (goldsmith), Pipa (Rajput prince), and women disciples Padmavati and Sursuri.

4.6 Kabir

Period: ~1398–1518 | **Place:Varanasi/Kashi** | **Guru:Ramananda** | **Occupation:** weaver (julaha)

- Kabir taught **one God** and used **Ram, Hari, Govind, Allah, and Sahib** interchangeably for the formless absolute (**nirguna**).
- He **rejected** idol worship, caste, the thread ceremony (janeu), pilgrimage, mosque ritualism, Vedic authority, and Brahman supremacy.
- He **accepted** the guru, inner experience, and honest householder life, and did **not** require sanyasa or monasticism.
- His famous doha runs: *"Pahan puje Hari mile, to main pujun pahar"* — if worshipping stone finds God, I shall worship a mountain.
- Another famous doha runs: *"Kabira khada bazaar mein, sabki mange khair"* — standing in the marketplace, he wishes well to all.
- **Bijak** is the chief compilation of Kabir's verses, with **Ramaini**, **Sabda**, and **Sakhi** sections.
- Dialogues of Kabir with disciple **Dharamdas** are collected in *Amarmul* — not the same as Bijak.
- His verses also appear in the **Adi Granth** (Sikh) and **Panchvani** (Dadu Panth compilation).
- Kabir died at **Maghar** on the UP border, deliberately challenging the belief that dying in Kashi alone gives moksha.
- **Kabir Panth** followers later split into the **Kabir Chaura (Varanasi)** branch and the **Dharamdasi (Chhattisgarh)** branch.
- **Sant Kabir Nagar** district in UP is named after him, making him highly UPPCS-relevant.
- Kabir wrote in **Sadhukkadi**, a mixed Hindi dialect that Raheem called *"panchranga"* (five-coloured).

> **Logic:** Kabir and Guru Nanak were separate persons, and Kabir did not found Sikhism. Kabir belongs to the **15th century**, while Nanak's life begins in **1469**.
>
> **UP saint: Malukdas** (b. **1574**, **Kada**, Kaushambi (कौशांबी)) is a separate nirguna sant of the Ganga (गंगा) belt — do not fold him into Kabir.

4.7 Guru Nanak

Dates:1469–1539 | **Birthplace:** Talwandi/**Nankana Sahib** (Ravi (रावी), Punjab) | **Family:** Khatri caste

- **Mardana** was Nanak's Muslim rabab player, lifelong disciple, and travel partner — **Mardana** was Nanak's **disciple**, not his guru.
- Nanak taught **Ik Onkar** (one God), equality of all humans, honest living, **nam simran** (remembrance), and **seva** (selfless service).
- His **three pillars** were Kirat karo (honest work), Naam japo (remember God), and Vand chhako (share with others).
- He rejected caste, idol worship, empty ritual, and ascetic escape from the world, but accepted **grihastha** (गृहस्थ) (householder life).
- Nanak undertook **five udasis** (travels) across India, Sri Lanka, Tibet, Mecca, Medina, and Baghdad to spread his universal message.
- **Japji Sahib** is the morning prayer he composed, and it begins the Guru Granth Sahib.
- The Guru Granth Sahib contains **974 hymns** by Nanak and also verses by Kabir, Baba Farid, Namdev, and Ravidas, making it a syncretic canon.
- Nanak established the **Kartarpur** sangat (community), which became the model for later Sikh Gurudwara institutions.
- He was a contemporary of **Chaitanya** (1486–1533) and lived before **Tulsidas** (whose Ramcharitmanas dates to ~1574).
- Nanak did not call himself Hindu or Muslim: *"Na koi Hindu, na Musalman"* was his first statement after enlightenment at Sultanpur.
- He lived under **Sikandar Lodi** (सिकंदर)'s Delhi (and later early Mughals). He founded Sikh sangat practice including **Guru ka Langar (लंगर)**.
- His equality line runs: God knows a person's virtues and does not ask caste, for there is no caste in the next world.

4.8 Chaitanya Mahaprabhu

Dates:1486–1533 | **Birth name:** Vishvambhar Mishra | **Place:Nabadwip**, Bengal | **Tradition:Gaudiya Vaishnavism**

- Chaitanya was also called **Gauranga** (golden-complexioned) and **Mahaprabhu** (great master).
- His guru was **Keshav Bharati**, from whom he received **sanyasa** initiation.
- He used **sankirtan** (congregational Krishna chanting with mridanga and kartals) to democratise devotion.

- His **Radha–Krishna** love symbolism drew on the **Bhagavata Purana (पुराण)**, and his philosophy was **achintya-bhedabheda** (inconceivable difference-in-unity).
- He took **sanyasa** at age 24 and settled at **Puri** (पुरी) (Jagannath (जगन्नाथ) temple) for the rest of his life.
- Disciples **Rupa Goswami** and **Sanatana Goswami** systematised theology at **Vrindavan** (वृंदावन) as part of the Six Goswamis.
- **Hussain Shah** (Bengal Sultan) respected Chaitanya, and Chaitanya also visited **Krishnadevaraya (कृष्णदेवराय)'s** court.
- Chaitanya sparked a **Bengali literary awakening** and inspired **Chaitanya Charitamrita** (Krishnadas Kaviraja (कविराज)), a biography in Bengali.
- In the four-saint chronology, **Chaitanya** comes **last** after Namdev, Kabir, and Nanak.
- The modern **ISKCON** (Hare Krishna movement) traces its lineage to Chaitanya.

4.9 Surdas, Tulsidas & Dadu Dayal

Saint	Dates	Tradition	Key work	Guru/link
Surdas	1478–1581	Krishna saguna (Braj)	**Sursagar**	**Vallabhacharya** (Pushti Marg / Shuddhadvaita)
Tulsidas	1532–1623	Rama saguna (Awadhi)	**Ramcharitmanas** (~1574)	—
Dadu Dayal	1544–1603	Nirguna (Rajasthan)	**Dadu Panth** hymns	— (Nipakhi non-sectarian)

Surdas: - Surdas belonged to the **Braj region (UP)**, the Mathura-Vrindavan belt, and tradition says he was **born blind**. - **Sursagar** contains about **5000 padas** on **Bal Krishna** (childhood), and **vatsalya rasa (रस)** is the dominant mood. - His other works include **Sahitya (साहित्य) Lahari** (literary waves) and **Sur Saravali**. - Surdas was part of the **Ashtachap**, the eight poet-disciples of Vallabhacharya and Vitthalnath.

Tulsidas: - Tulsidas was born at **Rajapur** (**Chitrakoot** (चित्रकूट) district, UP — not Banda in current keys) and worked in **Banaras/Ayodhya (अयोध्या)**. He was a contemporary of **Akbar and Jahangir (जहाँगीर)**; wife's name was **Ratnawali** (not Geetawali). - **Ramcharitmanas** (~1574) is an Awadhi retelling of the Ramayana (रामायण) in **doha-chaupai** form, **not** Sanskrit (a common trap). - His other works include **Vinay Patrika** (petition to Rama), **Kavitavali** (Braj), **Hanuman Chalisa**, **Dohavali**, and **Gitavali**. - Tulsidas made the Ramayana a **household text** in north India, presenting Rama as an accessible hero-god who combines duty, family, and devotion. - Both Hindus and Muslims respected him in his time, and tradition says **Akbar** (अकबर) acknowledged him.

Dadu Dayal: - Dadu Dayal was born in **Ahmedabad** (अहमदाबाद) and worked in **Rajasthan** (थार) (Sambhar, Naraina near Jaipur). - **Nipakhi** means a non-sectarian path that rejected Hindu-Muslim labels. - The **Dadu Panth** had three branches: **Virakta** (ascetic), **Naga** (नागा) (warrior), and **Sthandhari** (householder). - His 52 disciples were called **Bavanstambh** (52 pillars).

4.10 Mirabai & Bhakti Women Poets

Poetess	Composition	Tradition	Period
Andal	Tiruppavai, Nachiyar Tirumozhi	Tamil Alvar (only woman Alvar)	~8th c.
Mirabai	Padas/bhajans to Krishna	Mewar/Rajasthan saguna	~1498–1547
Daya Bai	**Vinay Malika**, Dayabodh	Charandasi	18th c.
Sahajobai	**Sahaj Prakash**	Charandasi	18th c.
Son Kumari	**Poem of Swam Beli**	—	—

- **Mirabai** was born in **Kudaki/Merta** (father **Ratan Singh Rathore**) and married **Bhojraj**, son of **Rana Sanga (सांगा)**, but defied the Rajput court for **Krishna** (कृष्ण) devotion. She composed *Rag-Govind*; some stems pair her with the Buddhist idea that the world is full of sorrow.
- She composed in **Rajasthani/Hindi** and expressed **madhurya bhava (भाव)** (love for Krishna as divine lover).
- Her renunciation of royal duty challenged **patriarchy and Rajput izzat codes**.
- **Andal** is the only **woman Alvar**; she wore the garland meant for the temple deity and wrote bridal mysticism to Vishnu.
- **Charandas** (Delhi, 18th century) was guru of both **Daya Bai** and **Sahajobai**.
- **Daya Bai** wrote **Vinay Malika**.
- **Sahajobai** wrote **Sahaj Prakash**.
- **Son Kumari** wrote **Poem of Swam Beli**.
- The wrong pair in match stems is **Gangabai — Ganesh Dev Leela**.
- Bhakti opened space for women to **sing, compose, and lead congregations**, which was rare in orthodox Vedic ritualism.

4.11 Vedanta Philosophy

Philosopher	School	Key idea
Shankaracharya (शंकर) (8th c.)	**Advaita**	Non-dual Brahman; world = maya
Ramanuja (11th–12th c.)	**Vishishtadvaita**	Qualified non-dualism; prapatti (surrender)
Madhvacharya (13th c.)	**Dvaita**	Dualism; God and soul distinct
Nimbarka (13th c.)	**Dvaitadvaita** (द्वैताद्वैतवाद)	Simultaneous unity and difference
Vallabhacharya (16th c.)	**Shuddhadvaita** (शुद्धाद्वैतवाद)	Pure non-dual Krishna bhakti; pushti marg

- **Vallabhacharya (1479–1531)** was born at **Champaranya** and founded **Pushti Marg** (path of grace) centred on **Krishna** as **Srinathji** at **Nathdwara** (later Rajasthan).
- **Pushti** means divine grace — salvation comes through Krishna's favour, not ritual merit alone.
- Vallabhacharya's **Ashtachap** were eight poet-disciples including **Surdas**; **Vitthalnath** (his son) continued the line.

- **Ramanuja** taught **Vishishtadvaita**.
- **Madhva** taught **Dvaita**.
- **Nimbarka** taught **Dvaitadvaita**.
- **Vallabha** (वल्लभ) taught **Shuddhadvaita**.
- **Ramananda** popularised **Ramanuja-related** ideas in the north and bridged southern philosophy and northern bhakti.
- **Vallabhacharya** was guru to **Surdas**.
- **Shankara's mathas** were at Sringeri (south), Puri (east), Dwarka (द्वारका) (west), and Joshimath (north), covering the four (चातुर्याम) corners of India.
- **Ramanuja's** major works are **Sri Bhashya** (commentary on Brahma Sutra) and **Gita Bhashya**, and his temple is at **Srirangam**.
- **Madhva** was headquartered at **Udupi** (Karnataka), worshipped **Vishnu/Krishna**, and founded 8 mathas.
- All five systems are **Vedantic** because they derive from the Upanishads (उपनिषद्), Brahma Sutra, and Gita, but they differ on the soul-God relationship.

4.12 Nath Sect (Nathpanthis) & Related Ascetic Groups

- **Matsyendranath** is regarded as the founder or first Nath, and **Gorakhnath** was the chief systematiser in the 11th–12th century.
- Tradition speaks of **Nine Naths** (Nava Nath), and the sect is also called **Kanphata Yogis** because of the split-ear earring initiation.
- Nath practice includes **hatha yoga** (asana (आसन) and pranayama (प्राणायाम)), **breath control (kumbhaka)**, meditation, and alchemy (rasayana).
- Key texts include **Goraksha Shataka** and **Hatha Yoga Pradipika** (Swatmarama, 15th century, Nath tradition).
- The Nath anti-caste strand parallels bhakti egalitarianism, but the Nath path is **yogic ascetic**, not devotional kirtan or poetry.
- **Gorakhpur (UP)** is strongly associated with the Gorakhnath cult, and **Gorakhnath Math** is a major centre.
- Nathpanthis influenced **Kabir** (anti-ritual vocabulary) and **Sufi circles** (breathing exercises).

Jogis, Siddhas & Nathpanthis (NCERT angle)

- NCERT groups **Nathpanthis**, **Jogis**, and **Siddhas** as north Indian ascetic communities that grew from craft and peasant backgrounds.
- **Jogis** (yogis) often wandered with alms-bowls and practised breath-control; **Siddhas** claimed perfected yogic powers.
- Tamil-region **Siddhas (Sittars)** are remembered as **monotheistic** and as condemning **idolatry** — a separate south stream from the north Nath list, but the same “Siddha” label appears in cultural-history stems.
- **Lingayats** of the Kannada region (Basavanna line) **questioned rebirth** and rejected caste hierarchy — full card in **§4.17**.
- These groups overlapped with Nath identity but were not identical — papers may use **"Nathpanthis"** as the formal sect name.

- Their path stressed **body discipline**, not **saguna Krishna/Rama kirtan** — do not classify them as mainstream Bhakti poets.
- Nathpanthis practised **Hath Yog**, and Sufis in the Nizamuddin circle adopted (अंगीकृत) yogic breathing — both statements are true.
- Nathpanthis differ from mainstream Bhakti because their focus is **body mastery and liberation through yoga**, not emotional devotion.

4.13 Sufi Saints — Overview

- **Sufism** is Islamic mysticism that seeks **direct experience of Allah** through love (**ishq-e-haqiqi**), not dry legalism alone.
- The word **"Sufi"** possibly comes from **suf** (wool), because early mystics wore coarse woollen robes.
- The **stages of the Sufi path** are Shariat (law), then Tariqat (path), then Haqiqat (truth), then Marifat (divine knowledge).
- A **khanqah** (ख़ानक़ाह) is a Sufi hospice used for worship, langar (free kitchen), charity, and disciple training.
- A **Shaikh** (शेख) is authorised to teach the path; **Sama** is the musical assembly. **Ulema** (उलेमा) are scholars of Islamic law — they are **not** a Sufi institution term.
- **Ba-shara** Sufis follow Sharia and include the Chishti and Suhrawardi orders.
- **Be-shara** Sufis are wandering qalandars and malangs who live outside strict law.
- **Wahdat-ul-Wujud** (वहदत-उल-वुजूद) (Ibn Arabi) teaches unity of existence, meaning God is everywhere.
- **Wahdat-ul-Shuhud** (वहदत-उश-शुहूद) (Ahmad Sirhindi) holds that God is separate from creation.
- The **pir–murid** bond means the disciple owes loyalty and service, while the pir gives spiritual instruction and **wazifa** (meditation formula).
- **Sama** is a musical devotional assembly and a **Chishti** hallmark; it involves dhikr, qawwali (क़व्वाली), and ecstasy.
- **Ziyarat** means pilgrimage to a **dargah** (Sufi tomb) to seek the saint's **barakat** (spiritual grace).
- **Al-Hujwiri** (Data Ganj Bakhsh) wrote **Kashf-ul-Mahjub** at **Lahore** — among the earliest major Sufi texts composed in the Indian subcontinent.
- **Al-Ghazzali** (d. 1112) reconciled Sufism with orthodox Islam, and his **Ihya-ul-Ulum** legitimised mysticism.
- Major Indian saints include **Moinuddin Chishti** (Ajmer), **Nizamuddin Auliya** (Delhi), **Baba Farid** (Ajodhan), and **Bahauddin Zakariya** (Multan).
- **Rabia of Basra** (8th century) was a pioneer woman Sufi who introduced the concept of **selfless divine love** without fear of hell or hope of heaven.

4.14 Moinuddin Chishti & Chishti Order

Arrived India: ~**1192** | **Settled:Ajmer** | **Died:1236** | **Title:Garib Nawaz** (benefactor of the poor)

- **Chishti principles** include absolute poverty (**faqr**), no property, no state service, an open kitchen (**langar**), and service to the poor.

- Moinuddin used **Hindawi/Hindi** for the masses, not Persian (फ़ारसी) alone, which was key to his mass influence.
- He defended **sama** (music in worship) despite orthodox opposition, and Chishtis became the most "Indian" Sufi order.
- **Futuh-ul-Salatin** records Moinuddin's arrival during Ghori's campaigns.
- Moinuddin became a disciple of **Khwaja Usman Haruni** at Nishapur. The Chishti order takes its name from **Chisht/Chishti Sharif (Afghanistan)**, not from a village in Ajmer.
- **Shaikh Salim Chishti** of Sikri (Fatehpur Sikri (फतेहपुर सीकरी)) received the title **Shaikh-ul-Hind**; tradition links Jahangir's birth to his blessing.
- Maratha (मराठा) chief **Raja (राजा) Sahu** (grandson of Shivaji (शिवाजी)) was the first to offer *nazr* at the Ajmer dargah among Maratha chieftains.
- The **Ajmer dargah (Urs festival)** draws Hindu and Muslim pilgrims and symbolises composite culture.
- The Chishti chain runs from Moinuddin (Ajmer) to **Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki** (Delhi, Mehrauli (मेहरौली)), then **Baba Farid** (Ajodhan/Pakpattan), then **Nizamuddin Auliya** (Delhi), and finally **Nasiruddin Chiragh-i-Delhi** (last great Delhi Chishti).
- After Nasiruddin, the Chishti silsilah **decentralised** into provincial branches in Gulbarga, Bijapur (बीजापुर), and Bengal.

Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki (Delhi)

- **Bakhtiyar Kaki** was Moinuddin's chief disciple who established the Chishti presence in **Delhi** (~Mehrauli).
- Tradition holds that Sultan **Iltutmish** (इल्तुतमिश) dedicated the **Qutub (कुतुब) Minar** (कुतुब मीनार) to this saint — a fact linking Delhi Sultanate (दिल्ली सल्तनत) architecture (सल्तनत स्थापत्य) to Chishti devotion.
- His dargah at **Mehrauli** (मेहरौली) remains a major pilgrimage site.

Baba Farid (Ganj-i-Shakar)

- **Fariduddin Masud** (~1173–1266) is called **Baba Farid** or **Ganj-i-Shakar** (treasury of sugar) for his sweet speech.
- He worked at **Ajodhan** (later **Pakpattan**, now Pakistan) and popularised the Chishti order in **Punjab and Haryana**.
- He composed in **Punjabi**; **134 of his verses** appear in the **Guru Granth Sahib** — a key Bhakti–Sufi syncretic fact.
- **Nizamuddin Auliya** was his most famous disciple.

Hamiduddin Nagaur & the five great Chishti shrines

- **Sheikh Hamiduddin of Nagaur** (Rajasthan) was a disciple of Moinuddin and wrote early **Hindawi** renderings of Persian mystical poetry.
- Medieval pilgrims revered **five great Chishti saints**: **Moinuddin** (Ajmer), **Bakhtiyar Kaki** (Delhi), **Baba Farid** (Ajodhan), **Hamiduddin** (Nagaur), and **Nizamuddin** (Delhi).
- **Ziyarat** to these **dargahs** cut across Hindu–Muslim lines and symbolised **composite culture**.

> **Logic: Moinuddin Chishti** is linked to **Ajmer**; **Nizamuddin Auliya** to **Delhi**, never Multan. Multan belongs to the **Suhrawardi** saint **Bahauddin Zakariya**.

4.15 Nizamuddin Auliya

Dates:1238–1325 | **Place:Delhi** (khanqah at Ghiyaspur/Nizamuddin Basti) | **Pupil of:Baba Farid**

- **Birthplace (UP Angle):** Nizamuddin Auliya was born at **Badaun (Uttar Pradesh (उत्तर प्रदेश))** in 1238.
- Nizamuddin was styled **Mehboob-e-Ilahi** (Beloved of God) and **Sultan-ul-Mashaikh** (King of Sheikhs). He saw the reign of **seven Delhi sultans**, but strictly avoided attending royal courts.
- His famous principle of detachment from the Sultanate: *"My house has two doors; if the Sultan enters through one, I will leave through the other."* (He refused an audience to Alauddin Khalji (अलाउद्दीन खिलजी)).
- **The 'Hunuz Dilli Dur Ast' Episode:** When Sultan Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq was returning from his Bengal campaign and sent a stern warning to Nizamuddin to leave Delhi before the royal entry, Nizamuddin famously uttered the Persian proverb: **"हनूज़ दिल्ली दूर अस्त" / "Hunuz Dilli Dur Ast"** (*Delhi is still far away*). The Sultan was crushed to death in the Afghanpur wooden pavilion before ever reaching Delhi.
- He taught love, tolerance, and service, fed the hungry during famines, and welcomed Hindus and Muslims alike.
- His famous saying runs: *"If a man of God has nothing to give, let him sigh with compassion for the poor."*
- **Amir Khusrau** (1253–1325) was his chief murid and a pioneer of **Urdu/Hindavi** literature.
- Khusrau is credited with developing **qawwali** (क़व्वाली), **khayal** (ख्याल), and **tarana** (तराना), and he wrote **Khaliq Bari**, a Hindi-Persian glossary.
- Khusrau's major works include **Tughlaqnama** (तुग़लक़नामा), **Khazain-ul-Futuh** (on Alauddin's victories), **Nuh Sipihr**, and **Qiran-us-Sadain**.
- **Fawaid-ul-Fuad** records Nizamuddin's malfuzat and was compiled by **Amir Hasan Sijzi**, **not** Amir Khusrau.
- Nizamuddin adopted **yogic breathing exercises** from the Nath tradition, and yogis called him **siddha**.
- He had conflict with **Alauddin Khalji** (अलाउद्दीन खिलजी) and later with **Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq** but remained independent of the state.
- **Nizamuddin–Multan** is **wrong**; Multan belongs to the **Suhrawardi** saint **Bahauddin Zakariya**.
- **Amir Khusrau's** guru was **Nizamuddin Auliya**.
- Nizamuddin is buried at Delhi, and **Khusrau's grave** is adjacent; both tombs are major pilgrimage sites.

4.16 Suhrawardi, Qadiri & Naqshbandi Orders

Feature	Suhrawardi	Qadiri	Naqshbandi
State patronage	**Accepted**	Variable	Mughal (मुग़ल) court contact
Region	**Multan/Punjab**	Pan-India	Central Asia → north India
Key figure (India)	**Bahauddin Zakariya**	Abdul Qadir Jilani line	**Ahmad Sirhindi**
Syncretism	Moderate (नरम दल)	Moderate	**Opposed**
Music/sama	Less emphasis	Variable	**Opposed**

- The core contrast between **Chishti and Suhrawardi** orders is poverty versus patronage.
- **Bahauddin Zakariya** also wrote **Risala** works on Sufi practice, and his tomb at Multan is a major shrine.

- **Qadiri saints in India** include Shah Nimatullah, Mian Mir (who laid the foundation of Harmandir (हरमंदिर) Sahib (हरमंदिर साहिब)), and Shah Badakhshani.
- **Ahmad Sirhindi (1564–1624)** was called **Mujaddid Alf-i-Sani** (Renewer of the Second Millennium).
- Sirhindi opposed **wahdat-ul-wujud** (pantheistic unity) and demanded strict **Sharia**, **jizya** (जज़िया), and separation from Hindu practices.
- He advocated **wahdat-ul-shuhud** (unity of appearance, not existence), holding that God is transcendent, not immanent in creation.
- **Jahangir** (जहाँगीर) imprisoned Sirhindi in **Gwalior fort** for two years but later released him with honour.
- Naqshbandi ideology influenced **Aurangzeb (औरंगजेब)'s** orthodox policies and later **Waliullah/Wahhabi** revivalism.
- The **Firdausi (फिरदौसी) / Firdousia** silsilah spread mainly in **Bihar** under **Shaikh Sharfuddin Yahya Maneri**.
- **Shah Muhammad Ghaus** (Shattari) accepted Krishna among the *Auliyas*; he translated Hatha-yoga *Amritkund* as *Bahar-al-Hayat* and wrote *Jawahir-i-Khamsa*; close to Humayun (हुमायूँ) and Tansen (तानसेन).

4.17 Regional Bhakti Traditions (NCERT / coaching map)

Standard UPPCS syllabi test regional strands beyond the Gangetic "sant" line. Each block below is one - ready card.

Karnataka — Basavanna & Virashaiva/Lingayat movement

Period:12th century | **Place:Basavakalyan** (Kalyani Chalukya (चालुक्य) / Kalachuri court) | **Patron context:** King **Bijjala II**

- **Basavanna** (Basaveshwara (बसवेश्वर)) was minister, philosopher, and social reformer who led the **Virashaiva/Lingayat** movement in Karnataka.
- Followers wear **Ishtalinga** (personal Shiva linga) on the body — direct devotion without Brahman priest mediation.
- He founded **Anubhava Mantapa** at Basavakalyan — a democratic forum where saints of all castes debated spirituality; **Allama Prabhu** presided.
- **Akkamahadevi** was a woman saint of this line who renounced marriage and composed **Vachanas** to Shiva.
- Core ideas: **Kayaka** (honest work as worship) and **Dasoha** (sharing surplus with society).
- **Vachana** literature in **Kannada** spread anti-caste, anti-ritual Shaiva Bhakti — distinct from Tamil temple Alvar/Nayanar tradition.
- The movement faced backlash; many **Sharanas** (devotees) were persecuted after court conflict — but Lingayat identity survived as a major reform strand.

Maharashtra — Varkari sampradaya (Vithoba of Pandharpur)

Saint	Period	Key work / trait
Jnaneshwar (Jnanadeva)	13th c.	**Jnaneshwari** — Marathi commentary on the **Bhagavad Gita** in **ovi** metre

Saint	Period	Key work / trait
Namdev	~1270–1350	Early Varkari; **61 hymns** in Guru Granth Sahib; often cited as Islam-influenced among Maharashtra sants
Eknath	16th c.	Revived Varkari tradition; commentary on Jnaneshwari
Tukaram (तुकाराम)	17th c.	**Abhangas** to Vithoba; peak of Marathi popular Bhakti

- **Varkari** means pilgrim — devotees walk to **Pandharpur** for the **Ashadhi/Kartiki wari** (annual pilgrimage).
- The deity is **Vithoba/Viththal** (Krishna standing on a brick) — **saguna** Krishna Bhakti in the Deccan (दक्कन).
- **Jnaneshwar** was initiated by his elder brother **Nivruttinath** and made the Gita accessible in Marathi for farmers and artisans.
- **Tukaram** used simple **abhangas** and attacked empty ritual — often paired with Namdev in chronology traps (Namdev is earlier).

Odisha/Bengal — Jayadeva & Gita Govinda

- **Jayadeva** (~12th century) composed **Gita Govinda** in **Sanskrit** at **Puri** (Odisha court tradition).
- The text celebrates **Radha–Krishna** love in **madhurya rasa** and deeply influenced later **Bengal Vaishnavism** and **Chaitanya's** Krishna cult.
- **Gita Govinda** is **not** the Bhagavad Gita — a common swap trap.

Assam — Shankaradeva

- **Shankaradeva** (15th–16th century) spread **Vaishnava Bhakti** in **Assam** through **Eka Sarana** (one-refuge) Krishna devotion.
- He translated and adapted the **Bhagavata** story in **Assamese** (**Kirtana-ghosha**) and founded **satra** (monastic–cultural centres).
- His **nam-kirtan** congregations paralleled north Indian sankirtan but used Assamese language and local performance forms.

Gujarat — Narsi Mehta

- **Narsi Mehta** (~15th century, Junagadh (जूनागढ़)) was a Krishna Bhakti poet who composed **bhajans** in **Gujarati**.
- His **"Vaishnav jan to"** hymn (praising a true Vaishnava's compassion) later became globally known through Gandhi (गांधी)'s use.
- He belonged to the **saguna Krishna** stream contemporary with **Narsinh Mehta**-era Gujarat Bhakti milieu.

4.18 Bhakti–Sufi Synthesis & Composite Culture

- **Raskhan** (Sayyid (सैयद) Ibrahim (इब्राहिम)) wrote *Prem Vatika* and *Sujan Raskhan* on Krishna in **Braj**. **Rasik Priya** (रसिक प्रिया) is by **Keshavdas**, not Raskhan.
- **Malik Muhammad Jayasi** wrote *Padmavat* (पद्मावत), *Barahmasa*, *Akharawat*, and *Aakhiri Kalam*.

- The fair at **Dewa Sharif** (Barabanki, UP) centres on Sufi saint **Haji Waris Ali Shah** (हाजी वारिस अली शाह).
- **Amir Hasan** (Hasan-i-Dehlavi) is called the **Sadi of India** for his ghazals — not Amir Khusrau.
- **Amir Khusrau** was a court poet–musician in the Chishti circle, **not** a Bhakti sant.
- Bhakti and Sufism were **separate religious paths**, but in north India they shared **social space**, **vernacular song**, and **egalitarian ethics**.
- Historians describe this as the meeting of **"great traditions"** (Sanskrit/Persian elite religion) and **"little traditions"** (local deity cults, folk (लोक) devotion).

Bridge	What it shows
Guru Granth Sahib	Verses of **Kabir**, **Namdev**, **Ravidas**, and **Baba Farid** in one scripture
Kabir in Kashi	Lived in a city of **temples, mosques, and Chishti influence**; used Ram and Allah as names of one God
Nizamuddin circle	**Amir Khusrau's** qawwali and **yogic breathing** from Nath yogis
Chishti sama	Musical ecstasy paralleled **bhajan/kirtan** congregations
Dargah ziyarat	Hindu and Muslim pilgrims at **Ajmer** and **Delhi** shrines

- **Composite culture** does **not** mean all saints mixed doctrines — **Ahmad Sirhindi** and **Kabir** rejected syncretic ritual, while **Chishti hospices** practised open kitchens for all faiths.
- **Akbar's sulh-i-kul** (universal peace) drew on this atmosphere but is **Mughal state policy**, not a Bhakti or Sufi sect teaching.

How historians study Bhakti–Sufi (sources fact)

Source type	Examples	Use
Hagiography	*Bhaktamal*, saint biographies	Ideals of saints — often idealised
Hymn compilations	Tevaram, Divya Prabandham, Bijak, Adi Granth	Actual devotional language
Sufi malfuzat	**Fawaid-ul-Fuad** (Nizamuddin conversations)	Teachings of Chishti masters
Inscriptions & travellers	Dargah records, Ibn Battuta (इब्न बतूता) on khanqahs	Patronage and pilgrimage

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4.9 Master Fact-Locks — Regional Saints, Sacred Geography & Medieval Literature

Category / Entity	Specific Details & Exam Anchors	Geographic / Cultural Lock
Guru Ghasidas (1756–1850)	Born Dec 1756 at **Giraudpuri** village (Balodabazar-Bhatapara dist, Chhattisgarh) to **Mahangu** and **Amarautin**. Founded the **Satnami movement** in Chhattisgarh opposing idolatry, caste hierarchy, and meat/liquor consumption.	Giraudpuri, Chhattisgarh

Category / Entity	Specific Details & Exam Anchors	Geographic / Cultural Lock
Namdev's Spiritual Lineage	Disciple of **Visoba Khechar**, who initiated him into mystical realization of the omnipresent, formless aspect of God. Tailor by caste; central pillar of **Varkari sampradaya**.	Narsi, Maharashtra / Pandharpur
Chaitanya Mahaprabhu	Born 1486 at **Nadia (Navadvipa, Bengal)** in a Brahmin family; father **Jagannatha Mishra**, mother **Shachi Devi**. Childhood name was **Nimai** (Vishwambhar Mishra). Preached ecstatic Krishna-bhakti (Gaudiya Vaishnavism).	Nadia, West Bengal
Ajmer Dargah & Marathas	**Raja Sahu** (grandson of Chhatrapati Shivaji) was the **first Maratha Chieftain** to send and offer *nazr* (ceremonial offering) at the Dargah of Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti at Ajmer.	Ajmer, Rajasthan
Nizamuddin Auliya Titles	Adorned with titles **Mehboob-i-Elahi** ("Beloved of God") and **Sultan-ul-Mashaikh** ("King of Saints"). Called *Yogasiddha* for adept mastery of yogic breathing (pranayama).	Delhi (Ghiyaspur)
Medieval Romance / Mathnavi Literature	• **Chandayan** — composed by **Mulla Daud** (early Awadhi Sufi mathnavi, Lorik-Chanda tale) • **Padmavati Katha** — composed by **Damodar Kavi** • **Rag Vibodh** — composed by **Somnath** (musicology) • **Ashiqa** — composed by **Amir Khusrau** • **Premvatika** & **Sujan Raskhan** — composed by **Raskhan** (Sayyid Ibrahim) in pure Braj Bhasha	Persian & Regional Vernaculars
Christianity Exam Facts (Ghatnachakra)	• **Birthplace of Jesus Christ: Bethlehem** (near Jerusalem) • **Easter:** Celebrates the **Resurrection of Jesus Christ** on the third day after crucifixion • **Good Friday:** Commemorates the sacrificial crucifixion and death of Jesus Christ on Friday • **Saint Francis of Assisi (1181/82–1226):** Celebrated Christian patron saint revered for his extraordinary love for birds and animals.	Judea / Assisi (Italy)

4.10 The 12 Jyotirlingas of Lord Shiva (द्वादश ज्योतिर्लिंग)

No.	Jyotirlinga Shrine	State / Region	Associated River / Geographic Landmark
1	**Somnath**	Veraval, Saurashtra, Gujarat	Prabhas Patan, Arabian Sea coast
2	**Nageshwar**	Near Dwarka, Gujarat	Char Dham circuit
3	**Mahakaleshwar**	Ujjain, Madhya Pradesh	Shipra River (only south-facing / Dakshinmukhi)
4	**Omkareshwar**	Khandwa / Mandhata, Madhya Pradesh	Island in Narmada River shaped like 'Om'
5	**Kedarnath**	Rudraprayag, Uttarakhand	Mandakini River, Garhwal Himalayas
6	**Kashi Vishwanath**	Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh	Holy Ganges River
7	**Baidyanath (Vaidyanath)**	Deoghar, Santhal Parganas, Jharkhand	Historic pilgrimage center

No.	Jyotirlinga Shrine	State / Region	Associated River / Geographic Landmark
8	**Trimbakeshwar**	Nashik, Maharashtra	Source of the Godavari River
9	**Grishneshwar**	Verul (near Ellora Caves), Maharashtra	Near Daulatabad/Aurangabad
10	**Bhimashankar**	Sahyadri Hills (near Pune), Maharashtra	Source of Bhima River
11	**Mallikarjuna Swamy**	Srisailam, Andhra Pradesh	Nallamala Hills, Krishna River
12	**Rameshwaram (Ramanathaswamy)**	Rameswaram Island, Tamil Nadu	Pamban Island, Gulf of Mannar